

Storage in woods

OOOMS USB sticks are custom made wooden USB drives, which can be made from the wood selected by the artisan

SSD for cellphones

Samsung and Toshiba has developed DDR 2.0 NAND flash memory for smartphones that gives 400MBps transfer speed

Toshiba's 25th Anniversary of Laptop Innovation – from T100 to R700

Digit had the opportunity to visit the Toshiba Information Equipment (TIH) factory in Hangzhou, China, on 24th June. The event was their 25th anniversary of manufacturing notebooks.

TIH Factory Visit – Dedication to Quality

Calling it the “25th Anniversary of Laptop Innovation and Quality”, Toshiba showed us the dedication it has for solid engineering with a tour of the TIH laptop plant, from the factory floor to the design and test centres. This is no Foxconn, we noticed no boredom or depression or sweat shop atmosphere here...just whole floors of assembly lines, made up of both humans and machines. With everybody concentrating at work, the near silence was extraordinary, only syncopated with machine rhythm. The chatter and smiles that broke out at lunchtime were rather startling, but expected – everybody likes a break from work.

With top-of-the line machinery and apparent cleanliness in the lines, nothing stood unused – small components flowed on tape to be fused to printed circuit boards with surface mounted technology, bigger components were carefully installed. We also noticed innumerable quality check points at every stage of production, ranging from Automatic Optical Inspection, Aging Testing, Finer Assembly Testing, to the human eye. This, according to Toshiba, is the single most important contrib-

utor to their quality, and super-low field failure numbers. That and their engineering team, who we were told are fearless in the face of technological hurdles – each an eagerly looked forward to challenge.

Toshiba India's Roadmap

Identifying India, China and Brazil as the top emerging markets, Toshiba aims to get a foothold in each. India has an astounding 46 per cent year-on-year growth and to this end, has started redoubling its efforts in marketing, retail, and service coverage. They've even got Sachin Tendulkar as their new ambassador, a sure sign of Toshiba's desire to progress in the booming Indian market. With him, they have launched an extensive cross-product media campaign conveying the message of “Excellence in Quality, Technology & Design”, as ambassador for Toshiba's laptops, LCD TVs, and home appliances.

In terms of their laptop portfolio in the country, Toshiba India had only 11 models in the country before April 2010, but intends to have a wide portfolio of 30 notebooks by October end, ranging from Rs. 19,000 to Rs. 70,000. Three of them were released on June 25th – the Portege R700, Qosmio F60, and W100 Libretto – some of the most exciting notebooks of 2010, which we've covered later in the article, and more extensively on www.thinkdigit.com.

Seeking to offer competitively priced products targeting institutions, corporations, and

the consumers, Toshiba has set its plans in motion, and has set an aggressive target of trebled sales and a double digit market share in India, which is currently pegged at 4 per cent by IDC India. In order to do this, they're about to expand their retail outlets as well as their service centres. From 71 service centres in 45 cities, to plan to have 81 centres in 55 cities by year end. Next, their 700 or so retail stores will grow to about 800 by the end of the year. Toshiba has also successfully formed retail partnerships with Reliance Digital and Croma. According to company officials, talks are also in advanced stages to partner with another major retail chain.

Innovative new laptops Portege R700 laptop

The quintessential lightweight business laptop, the 13.3-inch R700, weighs just 1.39 kg, and manages to squeeze in full powered Core i3 and i5 processors into a 0.88-inch thick frame, without sacrificing battery life or suffering heat dissipation problems. How Toshiba managed to do this is a tribute to their engineering skills, who managed to build an ultra-lightweight and super-strong honeycomb chassis out of magnesium. Also unprecedented on ultra-mobile laptops, is the presence of a 9-mm optical disk drive.

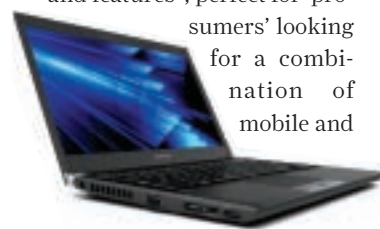
The i3 version costs Rs. 65,000, while the i5 version costs Rs. 75,000. A Portégé R700 with an i7 processor can be built to order, an SSD

can be opted for.

The R700 laptop also comes with some pretty cool software pre-installed, including an HDD Protection technology with 3D motion sensor (which parks the HDD head if excess vibration is detected – note, its sensitivity is adjustable), Toshiba Eco Utility (power management).

W100 Libretto

Called the world's first Windows 7 dual-touch-screen laptop, the Toshiba W100 Libretto weighs 819 grams, and has two 7-inch wide aspect capacitive multi-touch screens. The device is hailed by Toshiba as a mini-notebook that showcases an “unparalleled blend of high performance, mobility and features”, perfect for ‘prosumers’ looking for a combination of mobile and



Portege-r700

state-of-the-art computing. It is priced at Rs. 75,000.

We got our hands on the device on our visit to Toshiba's Hangzhou laptop factory, and we have to say, the W100 Libretto is seriously responsive in all aspects, and it looks great! The device certainly isn't conventional, and is something in between a laptop, a netbook, and a touchscreen tablet. This is why it can't be compared directly with an Apple iPad or Dell Streak. What really makes it stand apart is its